

TechPersona **STUDIO**

The *Pine Editorial* brand guide

Websites and quiet systems for service businesses.
Founder-led, calm, credible, and human, never another
AI vendor or faceless agency.

You're hiring a person, *not* *an agency.*

Pine Editorial should feel like a calm, capable studio run by one named human. Warm editorial moments with an operational backbone, serious enough for a law firm, grounded enough for a roofer, and never mistakable for a SaaS startup.

Founder-led, not faceless

A real person carries the brand. First-person voice, a real face, plain owner-language.

Calm, not loud

One rare accent holds all the warmth. Pine and stone do the rest of the work.

Premium, not precious

Soft depth, generous space, restrained color. Expensive, never over-art-directed.

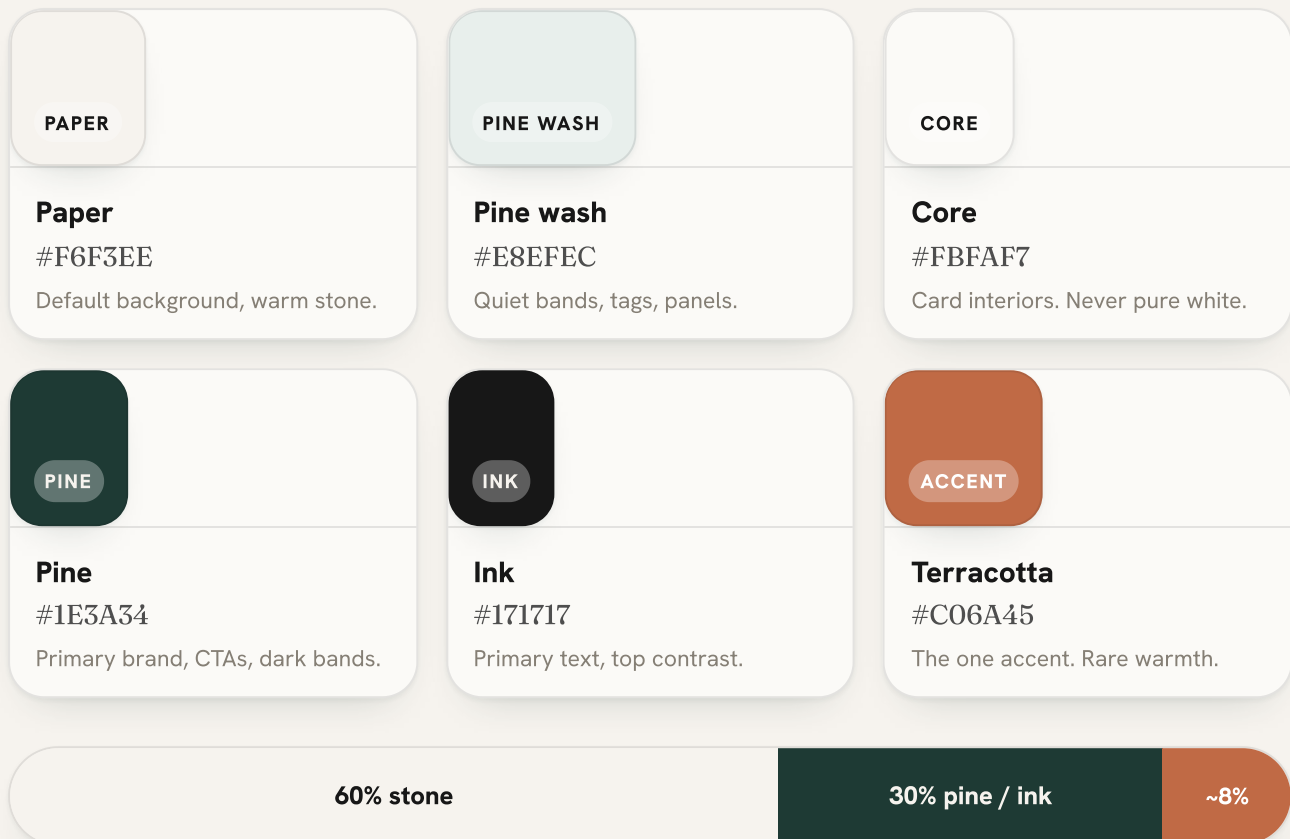
Operational, not decorative

Outcomes an owner gets in five seconds. The technology stays behind the wall.

Pine anchors. Stone calms.

Terracotta warms.

Pine is the trust anchor that survives the whole range. Stone neutrals keep it calm. Terracotta is warmth and emphasis only, never a base and never competing with pine.



Hanken leads. *Fraunces accents.*

Hanken Grotesk does ~90% of the work and keeps the brand operationally competent. Fraunces is the premium accent for hero moments, and the italic phrase is the signature, used once per section, not for whole sentences.

HANKEN GROTESK · PRIMARY · ~90% USAGE

Systems that turn inquiries into booked clients.

Regular 400 Medium 500 Semibold 600 Bold 700 ExtraBold 800

FRAUNCES · ACCENT · ~10% USAGE

Built for owners who value *response time.*

Use Fraunces for hero headlines and a single emphasized phrase. The italic, set in terracotta, is the brand's signature move.

RULES

Sentence case for headings. Tight tracking on display (-.045em).

Uppercase only for small tracked kickers. No serif body, no Title Case, no magazine layouts.

Double-bezel cards, island buttons, *soft depth*.

Cards are machined hardware: a pine-tinted outer shell wrapping a soft core. Buttons are rounded pills with a nested icon. Shadows are soft and pine-tinted, never hard offset blocks.

01 — websites

A site that gets found and converts.

Built to your brand. Found on Google and AI assistants.
Every page points to one next step.

One-time build

Get in touch →

Get my free audit →

See what I build



New booking

Sat · 9:48 pm



Replied in 2 min

while you were on a job



They find you first

A search or AI answer points to you, not the competitor.



They hear back fast

An answer lands in minutes, before they cool off.



They feel remembered

Follow-ups go out on their own.
The first job becomes the next.

THE VISUAL RULE

Show the human and the outcome, never the machinery. No phone-chatbot hero, no workflow diagrams, no dashboards. The customer journey is the only flow allowed.

The fastest ways to *weaken* the brand.

- ✗ Hard offset block shadows. The biggest "indie agency" tell, use soft, pine-tinted depth only.
- ✗ Purple/blue AI gradients, glassmorphism, or frosted blur on content.
- ✗ Workflow/node diagrams, dashboards, integration logos. The tech stays behind the wall.
- ✗ Pure white fields, a second accent color, or large fields of terracotta.
- ✗ Serif body or serif everywhere. Fraunces is a 10% accent.
- ✗ Fake metrics, fake case studies, faceless-agency framing.

• Do

Lead with the founder and the outcome
Use pine as the main trust signal
Keep terracotta rare and warm
Soft depth, squircle corners
Hanken for reading, Fraunces for moments
Speak plainly to owners

✗ Don't

Look like a generic AI agency
Look like a brutalist design studio
Overuse Fraunces or terracotta
Show the machinery
Use corporate jargon
Optimize for only one vertical

Copy-paste tokens.

Drop these into :root. Soft, pine-tinted depth is baked into the shadow tokens, never hard offset blocks.

```
--paper:#F6F3EE;  --paper-deep:#EFEAE1;  --pine-wash:#E8EFEC;  
--core:#FBFAF7;  --ink:#171717;  --ink-soft:#4E4E4E;  
--ink-faint:#857F75;  --pine:#1E3A34;  --pine-soft:#2E5148;  
--terra:#C06A45;  --terra-deep:#9F4F33;  --terra-light:#E7A282;  
--hair:rgba(23,23,23,.10);  
  
/* soft, pine-tinted depth — never hard offset blocks */  
--lift:0 1px 2px rgba(30,58,52,.04), 0 18px 40px -22px rgba(30,58,52,.30);  
--inner-hi:inset 0 1px 1px rgba(255,255,255,.7);  
--ease:cubic-bezier(.32,.72,0,1);
```

FONTS

Fraunces (ital + roman, 400–600) and Hanken Grotesk (400–800), from Google Fonts. Reference build:
[branding/techpersona_pine_editorial.html](https://branding.techpersona_pine_editorial.html).